

PORTAL QA · ROUND 6

Templates page audit

May 14, 2026

Round 6 verification of the Templates page. Dev claimed all 6 R5 findings shipped — live check confirms **2 of 6 fully closed** (R5 #1 RESET TO DEFAULT on Account Management, R5 #6 Custom header chrome trim). **4 R5 items remain partially open** — R5 #2 (+ Add phase) shipped the autofocus but missed the text pre-selection, used a red ring instead of brand blue, and didn't restyle the active phase row; + New template still doesn't auto-select the new entry; the new Custom's PHASES prompt copy drifted; and the typography sweep over-corrected the phase number badge (10px on portal, 11px on the original). Fresh side-by-side sweep surfaces a HIGH restructure of the template detail header (icon dropped out of its framed tile + a descriptive subtitle inserted) and a HIGH new sidebar treatment (coloured category pills on every row), plus 2 small styling drifts. 8 findings open total, sorted HIGH → LOW. Triage **FROM PREVIOUS QA** chips first — those are still-open items the dev has been sitting on across rounds.

8 findings · 3 HIGH · 0 MED · 5 LOW · 0 INFO

Status legend: HIGH blocks scanning / breaks workflow · MED meaningful divergence · LOW polish · INFO matches or working as intended.

Each finding carries two chips. **Severity** (HIGH / MED / LOW / INFO) maps to impact. **History tag** (**FROM PREVIOUS QA** = carried over from prior QA, **NEW** = surfaced this round) shows which items the dev has been sitting on vs. fresh observations. **FROM PREVIOUS QA** items need triage first.

HIGH severity

HIGH

NEW

Template detail header restructured — icon dropped out of its framed tile and a descriptive subtitle was inserted under the title

Where to see: Top → Templates → click any built-in template (Brand Refresh, Account Management, Content — 8 articles/mo). Compare the detail-pane header on the portal against the original.

Portal: The header rebuilt itself into a three-line block:

- Line 1: title (e.g. **Brand Refresh**) sitting on the left margin with no icon next to it.
 - Line 2: small outline service icon + a NEW descriptive subtitle (Brand Refresh reads *"One-time brand refresh engagement over 8–12 weeks"*; Account Management reads *"Account Management lifecycle template: 83 tasks across 12 phases"*).
 - Line 3: chip row (category pill, Click-to-edit hint, RESET TO DEFAULT, ARCHIVE).
- The icon is no longer in a framed tile — it's a 16px outline glyph tucked next to the subtitle. The whole header rhythm reads differently on the portal.

Original: Two-line block, much tighter:

- Line 1: dark rounded square tile holding the service icon (palette for Brand, chart for Account Management, etc.) sitting LEFT of the large title.
 - Line 2: chip row (category pill, Click-to-edit hint, RESET TO DEFAULT, ARCHIVE).
- No descriptive subtitle. The icon tile is the primary visual anchor on the left; the title sits to its right at the same baseline. Identifies the service in one glance — no counts, no prose.

Fix: Rebuild the template-header layout to match the original's two-line shape:

- **Re-add the framed icon tile** to the LEFT of the title. Dark square (~56px), rounded corners, service icon centered inside. The title sits to the right of the tile, vertically centred against it.
- **Drop the descriptive subtitle line.** "Brand Refresh" + the Brand pill in the chip row already says everything the subtitle says, and the count ("83 tasks across 12 phases") duplicates the PHASES subtitle below.
- **Keep the chip row flush left** under the title — same chips, same order, same spacing as today.

This change touches every template since the component is shared. Spot-check Brand Refresh, Account Management, Content, Copywriting, Creative, Email Marketing, Finance, Hosting, HR after the fix.

HIGH

FROM PREVIOUS QA

Active phase row in edit mode reads wrong — input ring is red instead of brand blue, "New phase" text isn't pre-selected, and the row chrome doesn't switch to the active treatment

Where to see: Top → Templates → click any template → click **+ Add phase** at the bottom of the phases list. Watch the new row that appears: the input outline, the number-badge fill, whether "New phase" is pre-selected, and whether **+ Add subtask** appears inside the row.

Portal: R5 #2 partial fix — the autofocus piece shipped, but the rest of the edit-mode treatment did not. Specifically:

- **Input outline ring is red** (roughly #DC2626 / error red). Reads as a validation error, not as the active edit ring.
- **"New phase" placeholder text is NOT pre-selected.** Caret lands at the end of the string; typing appends to "New phase" instead of replacing it. User has to Cmd+A first.
- **Number badge stays dark gray** ("1" on a 28,28,30 fill). No change between inactive and active states.
- **" + Add subtask" row is hidden** on the new phase. Inactive phase rows stay collapsed, which is fine — but the active/edit-mode row should expand to expose the subtask affordance the user is about to need.

Original: Same **+ Add phase** click yields a fully-styled active row:

- **Input outline ring is brand blue** (#0077C8 family) — same colour as the focus ring used on inline-rename across the rest of the app (Client hero, Notes).
- **"New phase" text is pre-selected** — text shows the standard blue selection highlight. The user types and the first keystroke replaces the placeholder. Enter commits.
- **Number badge goes solid brand blue** ("1" on a blue fill, white text). Distinguishes the active phase from the rest of the list at a glance.
- **" + Add subtask" row appears inside the active phase**, dashed border, just below the name input. Tells the user they can start adding subtasks immediately.

Fix: Three CSS swaps + one DOM addition for the active phase row:

- **Swap the focus ring colour** from red to #0077C8 (or the brand blue token the rest of the app uses). Red reads as error — wrong signal entirely for the edit-mode ring.
- **Add `ref.current?.select()` to the autofocus handler** so the placeholder text is highlighted on mount. Same pattern the Client hero's inline rename uses.
- **Switch the number badge to brand blue when the row is the active phase.** Use the same selected-state token the active-row treatment already uses elsewhere (Kanban active column, Notes selected note).
- **Render the " + Add subtask" row inside the active phase.** Gate by `isActive` on the phase-row component. Inactive rows stay collapsed; active row expands to show

the subtask add-affordance.

All four pieces together turn the active phase row into a clear edit-mode surface instead of the current half-baked treatment.



Sidebar template rows now render coloured category pills next to every template name

Where to see: Top → Templates → scan the left rail. Each row shows title + a coloured category pill on the portal; the original shows title + meta line only.

Portal: Every sidebar row pairs the template name with a coloured category pill: Brand Refresh + magenta **Brand** pill, Account Management + lavender **Account Management** pill, Content — 8 articles/mo + violet **Content** pill, Creative / Design + pink **Creative** pill, Email Marketing + magenta **Email** pill, Finance / Billing + amber **Finance** pill, Hosting / IT + blue **Web Development** pill, HR / Resourcing + green **HR** pill, and the New template entries get a gray **Custom** pill. Pills sit between the title and the right edge of the row, on the same line as the title.

Original: Sidebar rows are just title + meta line ("*8 phases · 7 onboarding items*"). No category pill in the row — the category is communicated in the detail header (the chip row's first pill). Sidebar reads as a clean inventory list; the rail's job is wayfinding, not categorisation.

Fix: Pick which surface owns the category signal. The original puts it in the detail-header chip row exclusively; the portal doubled up by adding it to every sidebar row too. Two options:

- **Match the original** (recommended) — remove the category pill from sidebar rows. Leave only title + meta. Category lives in the detail header chip row.
- If sidebar categorisation is valuable to keep, downgrade the pill to a small dot or a single character in front of the meta line — not a full coloured pill, which dominates the row and crowds the meta. But the original's choice (no pill in row) is the cleaner read. Either way, harmonise so the portal stops having two category surfaces fighting for attention.

LOW severity

LOW

FROM PREVIOUS QA

" + New template" still doesn't auto-select the new entry — right pane stays blank after the click

Where to see: Top → Templates → click + **New template** in the top-right of the left rail. Watch what happens immediately after the click.

Portal: Same shape as R5 #3 — partial fix held, the rest didn't ship. The button creates a new "*New template*" entry in the sidebar with a *Custom* pill and bumps the eyebrow count (24 ACTIVE → 25 ACTIVE). The right pane stays **blank** — whatever was open clears out and the new template is NOT selected. User has to find the newly-created row in the rail and click it. Only then does the name input auto-focus + select (that part finally works round 6). The auto-select step is still missing.

Original: Click + **New template** → entry appears in the sidebar AND becomes the selected row AND opens in the right pane AND the name field is focused with "New template" pre-selected. One click, ready to type. That's the full pattern — the portal nailed the focus + selection step but still needs the auto-select step on the row.

Fix: After creating the new template in the data layer, the click handler needs to also:

- **Set the new template as the selected row** in the rail state (same selection atom the click-row handler writes to).
- **Open the detail pane** with the new template's contents (already wired — selection drives the detail pane, so step one covers this).

The focus + select-text logic the dev already shipped takes over once the row is selected. So this is a one-line addition in the create handler.

LOW

FROM PREVIOUS QA

Newly-created Custom template uses different PHASES prompt copy than the existing Custom

Where to see: Top → Templates → click an existing Custom template (the one already in the rail from a prior session) and read the PHASES subtitle. Then click **+ New template**, click into the brand-new Custom entry, and read its PHASES subtitle. Two different sentences.

Portal: Two different prompts coexist:

- **Existing Custom** (created in a prior session) renders *"Describe how this template's phases are paced"* in italic next to the PHASES eyebrow. That matches the original.
- **Newly-created Custom** (fresh + New template click) renders *"Phases will appear as cards on the board."* in non-italic next to the PHASES eyebrow. Different sentence, different style. Drifted from the original.

Looks like the create handler writes a different default than the existing-Custom render path uses.

Original: Every Custom template — existing or newly-created — shows the same italic *"Describe how this template's phases are paced"* prompt next to the PHASES eyebrow. One prompt, one style, no drift between create paths.

Fix: Find the two places the default PHASES subtitle is set:

- The seed/initial-render path that the existing Custom uses (already correct — italic *"Describe how this template's phases are paced"*).
- The **+ New template** create handler's default (currently *"Phases will appear as cards on the board."* — wrong).

Unify on the italic original copy and remove the second sentence from the codebase. While there, audit any other default-copy fields the create handler writes (PROJECT BRIEF FIELDS, ONBOARDING CHECKLIST subtitles) to make sure none of them drifted the same way.

LOW

FROM PREVIOUS QA

Phase number badge over-corrected — portal is 10px, original is 11px (R5 #4 partial fix)

Where to see: Top → Templates → click any template with multiple phases. Look at the small numbered badge to the left of each phase title (1, 2, 3, etc.). Inspect computed font-size in DevTools.

Portal: R5 #4 typography sweep partially shipped:

- **Page H1** is now 24px (was 28px) — matches original. ✓
- **Page subtitle** is now 12px (was 16px) — matches original. ✓
- **Phase number badge** is now 10px — original is 11px. Portal over-corrected by 1px and went below the original. Visible at scale: in a 12-phase template (Account Management) the numbers read noticeably thinner against the same weight (600). ✗

Original: Phase number badge is 11px / weight 600 / dark grey background (rgb 28,28,30 — same as portal). Same shape, same colour, just 1px taller than the portal. The padding around the badge inherits from the same row height, so the 11px sits visually balanced inside the chip.

Fix: In the phase-row component's CSS (the rule that targets `.template-phase-num`), change *font-size* from `10px` to `11px`. Don't touch weight or background — those already match. Verify by inspecting `.template-phase-num` on the portal: computed font-size should read `11px` after the change.

LOW

NEW

Service-category badge inside template header restyled — gray plain pill became coloured solid pill with icon

Where to see: Top → Templates → click any template. The first pill in the detail header's chip row (left of the Click-to-edit hint) is the category badge — e.g. **Brand** on Brand Refresh, **Custom** on a new template.

Portal: Coloured solid pill carrying a small service icon and the category name. Brand Refresh shows a magenta pill with a palette icon + **Brand** text. Custom templates show a dark gray pill with a monitor icon + **Custom** text. The pill's fill matches the category colour family used in the sidebar pills (HIGH #2 above) and the service-icon colour family.

Original: Plain gray rounded pill with just the category text — **Brand**, **Custom**, no icon, no coloured fill. Sits flush against the title block and reads as quiet metadata, not as a second-tier brand element.

Fix: Drop the icon from inside the category pill and switch the pill back to the neutral gray fill the original uses. The category name alone carries the signal — the icon is duplicated by the new framed-tile icon being re-added per HIGH #1, so removing it from the pill avoids a third appearance of the same glyph on the surface.

LOW

NEW

"↓ Click any field to edit" hint pill shifted from brand blue to a warm orange

Where to see: Top → Templates → click any built-in template. Look at the small pill in the detail header's chip row that reads ↓ *Click any field to edit* (between the category pill and RESET TO DEFAULT).

Portal: Pill renders with a warm orange/amber fill (roughly #F59E0B family) and matching orange text + arrow. The colour reads as a warning or warning-adjacent surface — same hue family the MED severity chips use in QA docs. Visible on every built-in template that exposes the hint.

Original: Pill renders with the brand blue fill (#0077C8 family) and white/blue text + arrow. Reads as an instructional hint in the brand palette — same colour family the primary CTA buttons use, which signals "this is help text from us" rather than "this needs your attention".

Fix: In the hint-pill component (the one that wraps "↓ *Click any field to edit*"), swap the background + text colour tokens back to the brand blue scale used elsewhere on the surface (same scale as the **+ New template** button fill, RESET TO DEFAULT icon on hover, etc.). The orange tint reads as alert, which mis-signals the intent of the hint.

Build checklist

Every actionable finding (HIGH / MED / LOW). INFO items are listed in the body but not in the checklist. Tick each as it ships.

**HIGH**

Template detail header restructured — icon dropped out of its framed tile and a descriptive subtitle was inserted under the title

Rebuild the template-header layout to match the original's two-line shape:

- **Re-add the framed icon tile** to the LEFT of the title. Dark square (~56px), rounded corners, service icon centered inside. The title sits to the right of the tile, vertically centred against it.
- **Drop the descriptive subtitle line.** "Brand Refresh" + the Brand pill in the chip row already says everything the subtitle says, and the count ("83 tasks across 12 phases") duplicates the PHASES subtitle below.
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